

# The dataset behind three decisions

For this analysis, I used the TrustMRR 1,000-row dataset, frozen on 30 July 2026.

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The dataset contains company revenue, growth, business models, industry categories, payment platforms and performance indicators.

## BASIS THIS DATA, I ANALYSED

- 01 What SaaS business should I build?
- 02 Which company should I acquire?
- 03 Which payment gateway should I use?

Correlation-led • comparative •  
decision-focused

# Scale comes from customers—not followers

Rank correlations expose what moves with revenue across the dataset.

MRR ↔ revenue



0.89

Subscriptions ↔ MRR



0.90

Visitors ↔ revenue



0.60

Followers ↔ revenue



0.17

**Implication**

Build for recurring usage and paid conversion.

Audience size alone is a weak moat.

# The whitespace is a revenue-health copilot

A control layer that explains churn, conversion and gateway performance across the fragmented SaaS stack.

**Stripe**

**636** startups in dataset

**RevenueCat**

**189** startups in dataset

**REVENUE  
HEALTH COPILOT**

One view of growth quality

**Paddle**

**16** startups

**Lemon Squeezy**

**25** startups

Why now: payment data is fragmented, while follower count barely predicts revenue.

# Start narrow: diagnose “why MRR moved” in 60 seconds

The wedge is explanation, not another dashboard.

## WHO

Indie SaaS founders  
\$1k–\$100k MRR

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## WEDGE

Connect billing + traffic  
→ anomaly diagnosis

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## PRICE

\$49 / \$149 / \$399  
per month

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## MOAT

Anonymous  
benchmarks  
by category + gateway

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## Minimum lovable product

1. MRR bridge   2. churn alerts   3. conversion benchmark   4. gateway reconciliation

Avoid: generic AI writing, broad productivity and social dashboards—the dataset shows crowded categories with weak median economics.

# SetSmart is the best lead—not yet a blind buy

It combines growth, recurring revenue and a low asking multiple, but the quality of that growth needs verification.

| Target         | Ask     | MRR     | Rev. growth | MRR growth | Multiple |
|----------------|---------|---------|-------------|------------|----------|
| SetSmart       | \$499k  | \$15.7k | +29%        | +100%      | 0.8×     |
| Groups Watcher | \$500k  | \$21.4k | +20%        | +20%       | 2.2×     |
| Conductor      | \$1.25m | \$35.4k | +8%         | +10%       | 3.0×     |

BUY THESIS

Acquire the automated Instagram DM-to-booking wedge, then expand into a broader conversational revenue OS.

# The 0.8× multiple is attractive only if MRR is real

A four-part diligence gate prevents a cheap-looking asset from becoming an expensive mistake.

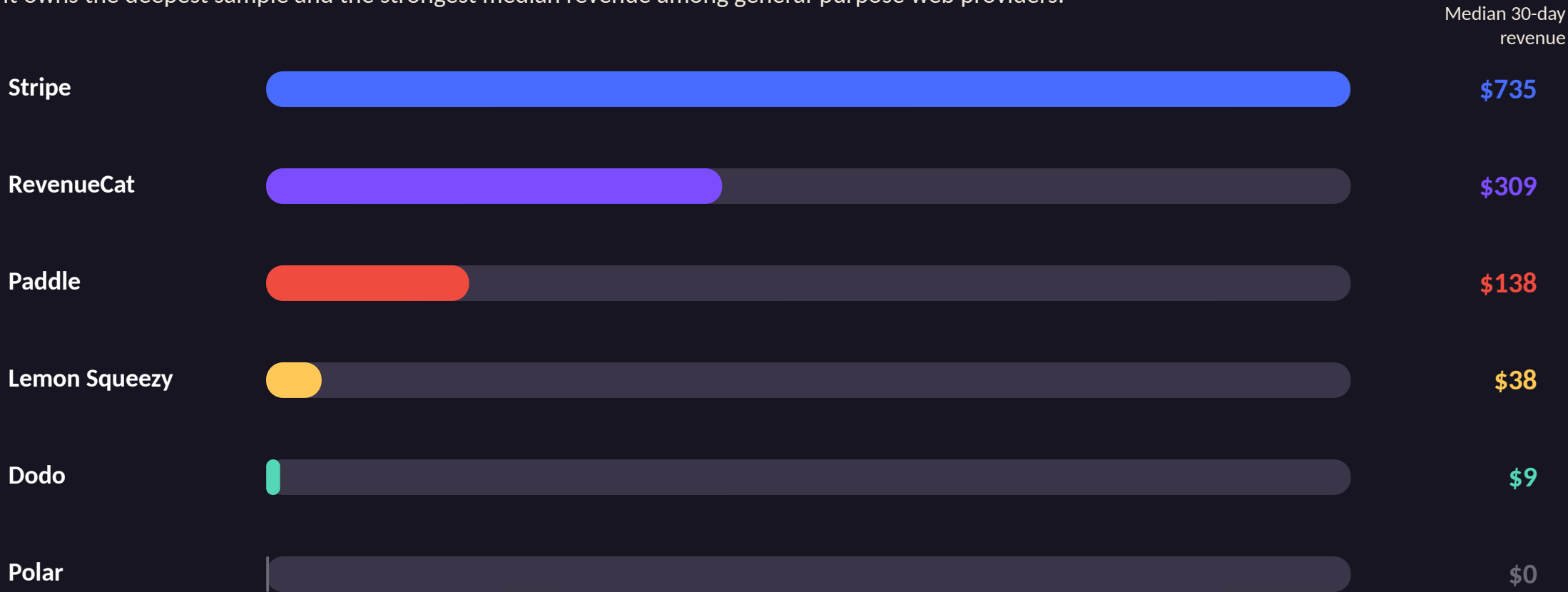
- |    |                        |                            |                                                                                       |
|----|------------------------|----------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 01 | <b>Retention</b>       | Logo churn < 4% monthly    |    |
| 02 | <b>Revenue quality</b> | MRR reconciles to cash     |    |
| 03 | <b>Platform risk</b>   | Meta API access is durable |    |
| 04 | <b>Concentration</b>   | No client > 10% MRR        |  |

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Walk away if the +100% MRR growth is migration, annual-plan timing or a single-customer spike.

# For web SaaS, Stripe is the default answer

It owns the deepest sample and the strongest median revenue among general-purpose web providers.



# Gateway performance is a signal—not proof of superiority

Provider choice is entangled with product type, maturity and platform.

## What the dataset says

**Stripe users show  
\$735 median 30-day revenue**

## What it does not say

**Switching to Stripe will  
create higher revenue**

### Decision rule

**Choose for product architecture  
first, then optimise economics.**

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Web billing • ecosystem • reporting → Stripe

**Correlation guides the shortlist; operating requirements make the final choice.**



# Build the intelligence layer. Buy the distribution wedge. Use Stripe at the core.

**BUILD**

## Revenue-health copilot

Turns fragmented billing data into an answer: “why did MRR move?”

**BUY**

## SetSmart, conditionally

Adds a live acquisition-to-booking workflow and a fast route to customers.

**PAY**

## Stripe first

Best fit for web SaaS; add RevenueCat only if mobile becomes core.

**One portfolio logic**

Acquire attention → measure conversion → protect recurring revenue.

# Test the thesis before committing capital

Each decision has a measurable proof point.

DAYS 1-30

## Prototype

Connect Stripe + RevenueCat; recruit 15 founders

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PROOF

5 weekly active testers

DAYS 31-60

## Validate

Run paid pilot; complete SetSmart diligence

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PROOF

≥ 5 paid accounts

DAYS 61-90

## Commit

Decide build-only vs acquisition + integration

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PROOF

Retention + payback pass

The dataset reveals where to investigate; customer evidence decides where to invest.